I often bunked classes too, and enjoyed all the sorts of stuff that boys get up to when they are together in a group. In class we used to do stuff like put a drawing pin on a chair for someone to unsuspectingly sit down on, and we generally gave the teachers a hard time. I wasn't really naughty; it was just normal, exuberant, teenage-boy stuff.

But there was one time my exuberance did make the papers, though – clearly a precursor of what my life as a professional cricketer would be like in the years to come. It was the 1992 Nuffield Week – the prestigious interprovincial under-19 cricket tournament (now called Khaya Majola Week) – and I was 18 and in matric.

The tournament was being held in Stellenbosch that year, and we were staying in the dormitories of a local school. My fellow Western Province XI teammates and I decided to go out the night before one of the games, knowing full well that we had a midnight curfew. If you weren't back by then, they would lock the doors. There were, I think, five or six of us, and we just happened to walk past a wedding. It was a large affair with many 'coloured' families in attendance, and one of the guests at the wedding happened to notice me.

As part of the coloured community, and because I had been playing senior cricket for a couple of years by then and therefore had a public profile, one of the guests recognised me and invited me in for a few drinks.

Obviously I had my mates with me and I couldn't just drop them, so I dragged them in as well. Predictably, one thing led to another. A few beers were consumed and, the next thing you know, it's 12.30 a.m. I thought we might be able to sneak in quietly, but of course they had already locked the doors to the dormitories. One of my teammates was really pissed by now, and he started banging on the doors and causing all sorts of kak. So we got bust. Our coach, Keith Richardson – one of the masters at Wynberg Boys' High – was notified. We were in deep shit.

All of us were banned for one game, and the story made the papers … but my name was the one that got dragged through the mud. A similar thing happened in 2001 when, in another moment of exuberance, some of my Proteas teammates and I decided to smoke a little weed in the West Indies. Everyone remembers that I was one of the *rokers*, while they probably couldn't name the other culprits. But more about that later.

So school … ja … The bottom line was that I was just not interested in spending any time in the classroom. As I said, my mind was on the sports